A listening corner for one Ace lobby.

EARF makes hi-fi and light in San Francisco, in cast acrylic tinted all the way through, in eight colours from Ember to Smoke. Tropos is a powered horn loudspeaker; Mantle, a record player whose plinth floats over a base lit at its edge; Hemisphere, a pendant; Core, a cordless table lamp. The first pair of Tropos played for the first time at our debut in San Francisco on 19 January 2027, in FOG Design+Art week.



RENDER · REPLACED BY A PHOTOGRAPH FROM THE DEBUT BEFORE SENDING

WHAT WE PROPOSE

A season-long EARF listening corner in one Ace lobby: a numbered pair of Tropos, a Mantle record player and Hemisphere pendants, in a tint chosen for the room, with listening sessions through the season. It starts as a residency and becomes a purchase if it works for Ace. Beside it, an Ace × EARF edition of Core, our cordless lamp, for the rooms or the shop.

WHY ACE HOTEL GROUP

- Ace has treated sound as part of the building: Devon Turnbull built the lobby system at Ace Hotel New York.
- Tivoli made a co-branded radio for Ace Sydney's rooms; Ace set the brief and the silkscreen.
- Elsewhere, hotels now commission listening rooms: OJAS's Listening Room at Patina Osaka; the Equipment Room at Hotel Magdalena, Austin, with Klipsch.
- A corner is smaller than a room: one season, one tint, no construction.

ACE HOTEL GROUP BRINGS

- The lobby, and the guests in it
- The programme: who plays, and when
- Its shop, for the Core edition
- Photography and its own channels

EARF BRINGS

- The system: Tropos, Mantle, Hemisphere, installed and tuned
- The Sessions: one album, start to finish, on set nights
- Core in an Ace tint, numbered
- Service through the season

How it could work.

An outline to discuss, not an offer. The ranges are those typical in published sources for licensed and co-branded design (furniture, lighting, consumer products); none of it is agreed, and every line is for counsel.

TERM	IN OUTLINE
Residency	A season (about three months): EARF installs and services; Ace hosts and programmes. A residency fee or a loan [to agree]. FOR COUNSEL
Purchase	At the end, Ace may buy the corner: 50% on order, the balance on installation, as commissions usually run. FOR COUNSEL
Core edition	Ace buys a numbered run (for example 100) at wholesale, about 40–50% of retail. FOR COUNSEL
Co-brand	"Ace × EARF" on the Core edition, under a licence of 1–3 years; each approves the other's use of its name. FOR COUNSEL
IP	EARF keeps the design; a credit line such as "The Listening Corner by EARF". FOR COUNSEL
Care	Insurance and liability for loaned equipment in a public lobby; a service contract if bought. FOR COUNSEL
Prices	A suggested retail price for the shop only: no resale price set (California). FOR COUNSEL

When.

FROM THE DEBUT	WHAT
The debut, 19 January	The pieces seen working, photographed
2–5 weeks after	This letter, with the photographs (February)
About 12 weeks after	A meeting in Milan, 13–18 April, or at the property
Mid-2027	The residency opens, in a city Ace chooses
With the Core run	The Ace edition of Core, numbered (est. autumn 2027)

What we'd send next

Photographs and a short film from the debut; drawings of the parts we'd design; samples of the eight tints in cast sheet; an edition sheet with sizes, colours and lead times.

What stays EARF's own

Tropos, Mantle and the tint system. An edition is designed around them and licensed for its own run; nothing here licenses EARF's products or its colours beyond it.

Who

[Your name], founder, EARF, San Francisco. [contact line].
Through business@acehotel.com (Atelier Ace business inquiries); press@acehotel.com in copy.